COLD WAR AND INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

COLD WAR SECURITY DILEMMA → ORIGINS WEIGHTING → CONTAINMENT SEQUENCE → KOREAN ESCALATION → THAW VERSUS CONTROL → BERLIN AND CUBA

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 →

STAGE 00 COLD WAR SECURITY DILEMMA

COLD WAR SECURITY DILEMMA · SECURITY BELT IN EASTERN EUROPE · READS BELT AS EXPANSION · USSR READS ENCIRCLEMENT · DEFENSIVE ACTS REPRODUCE HOSTILITY · MUST REMEMBER · TRUMAN CONTAINMENT, MARSHALL AID, NATO, SOVIET CONSOLIDATION AND THE · PACT FRAME ONE SEQUENCE, WHILE KOREA, CUBA, VIETNAM, DÉTENTE

USSR → security belt in eastern Europe → WEST → reads belt as expansion → CONTAINMENT → USSR reads encirclement → RESULT → defensive acts reproduce hostility → MUST REMEMBER: Truman containment, Marshall aid, NATO, Soviet consolidation and the Warsaw

CORE CLAIM
- USSR → security belt in eastern Europe
- WEST → reads belt as expansion
- CONTAINMENT → USSR reads encirclement

MECHANISM
- RESULT → defensive acts reproduce hostility
- MUST REMEMBER: Truman containment, Marshall aid, NATO, Soviet consolidation and the Warsaw
- Pact frame one sequence, while Korea, Cuba, Vietnam, détente, renewed tension and the

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1989-91 end phase changed its form.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Pact frame one sequence, while Korea, Cuba, Vietnam, détente, renewed tension and the.

01 →

STAGE 01 ORIGINS WEIGHTING

ORIGINS WEIGHTING · DEFINES FRIEND AND THREAT · POWER VACUUM · CREATES STRATEGIC STAKES · ATOMIC ASYMMETRY · RAISES MISTRUST · WARTIME LEGACY · BEGINS RIVALRY WITH LOW TRUST

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
IDEOLOGY → defines friend and threat	ATOMIC ASYMMETRY → raises mistrust	IDEOLOGY → defines friend and threat
POWER VACUUM → creates strategic stakes	WARTIME LEGACY → begins rivalry with low trust	POWER VACUUM → creates strategic stakes

CORE CLAIM
- IDEOLOGY → defines friend and threat
- POWER VACUUM → creates strategic stakes

MECHANISM
- ATOMIC ASYMMETRY → raises mistrust
- WARTIME LEGACY → begins rivalry with low trust

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- IDEOLOGY → defines friend and threat
- POWER VACUUM → creates strategic stakes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WARTIME LEGACY → begins rivalry with low trust.

02 →

STAGE 02 CONTAINMENT SEQUENCE

CONTAINMENT SEQUENCE · TRUMAN DOCTRINE AND MARSHALL PLAN · CZECHOSLOVAKIA HARDENS DIVISION · BERLIN BLOCKADE AND AIRLIFT · NATO, SOVIET BOMB AND COMMUNIST CHINA

1947 → Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan → 1948 → Czechoslovakia hardens division → 1948–49 → Berlin blockade and airlift → 1949 → NATO, Soviet bomb and communist China

CORE CLAIM
- 1947 → Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan
- 1948 → Czechoslovakia hardens division

MECHANISM
- 1948–49 → Berlin blockade and airlift
- 1949 → NATO, Soviet bomb and communist China

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1947 → Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan
- 1948 → Czechoslovakia hardens division

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1949 → NATO, Soviet bomb and communist China.

03 →

STAGE 03 KOREAN ESCALATION

KOREAN ESCALATION · NORTH INVADES · JUNE 1950 · UN/US FORCE · ADVANCES NORTH · ENTERS THE WAR · FRONTIER REMAINS NEAR 38TH PARALLEL

NORTH INVADES → June 1950 → UN/US FORCE → advances north → CHINA → enters the war → 1953 → frontier remains near 38th parallel

CORE CLAIM
- NORTH INVADES → June 1950
- UN/US FORCE → advances north

MECHANISM
- CHINA → enters the war
- 1953 → frontier remains near 38th parallel

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NORTH INVADES → June 1950
- UN/US FORCE → advances north

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CHINA → enters the war; 1953 → frontier remains near 38th parallel.

04 →

STAGE 04 THAW VERSUS CONTROL

THAW VERSUS CONTROL · KOREAN ARMISTICE AND AUSTRIAN TREATY · RHETORIC OF REDUCED TENSION · WARSAW PACT · BLOC INSTITUTIONALISED IN 1955 · HUNGARY 1956 · SOVIET SPHERE ENFORCED BY FORCE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
THAW → Korean armistice and Austrian treaty	WARSAW PACT → bloc institutionalised in 1955	THAW → Korean armistice and Austrian treaty
COEXISTENCE → rhetoric of reduced tension	HUNGARY 1956 → Soviet sphere enforced by force	COEXISTENCE → rhetoric of reduced tension

CORE CLAIM
- THAW → Korean armistice and Austrian treaty
- COEXISTENCE → rhetoric of reduced tension

MECHANISM
- WARSAW PACT → bloc institutionalised in 1955
- HUNGARY 1956 → Soviet sphere enforced by force

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- THAW → Korean armistice and Austrian treaty
- COEXISTENCE → rhetoric of reduced tension

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HUNGARY 1956 → Soviet sphere enforced by force.

05 →

STAGE 05 BERLIN AND CUBA

BERLIN AND CUBA · BERLIN WALL 1961 · DIVISION MADE PHYSICAL · CUBA 1962 · NUCLEAR CONFRONTATION PEAKS · COMMON RULE · AVOID DIRECT GENERAL WAR · STABILITY THROUGH RESTRAINT, NOT SETTLEMENT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
BERLIN WALL 1961 → division made physical	COMMON RULE → avoid direct general war	BERLIN WALL 1961 → division made physical
CUBA 1962 → nuclear confrontation peaks	RESULT → stability through restraint, not settlement	CUBA 1962 → nuclear confrontation peaks

CORE CLAIM
- BERLIN WALL 1961 → division made physical
- CUBA 1962 → nuclear confrontation peaks

MECHANISM
- COMMON RULE → avoid direct general war
- RESULT → stability through restraint, not settlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BERLIN WALL 1961 → division made physical
- CUBA 1962 → nuclear confrontation peaks

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMMON RULE → avoid direct general war; RESULT → stability through restraint, not settlement.

06 →

STAGE 06 GLOBAL COLD WAR MAP

GLOBAL COLD WAR MAP · KOREA, VIETNAM AND CHINA · LATIN AMERICA · CUBA AND CHILE · MIDDLE EAST · SUEZ AND ARAB-ISRAELI WARS · RENEWED CONFRONTATION AFTER 1979

ASIA → Korea, Vietnam and China

LATIN AMERICA → Cuba and Chile → MIDDLE EAST → Suez and Arab-Israeli wars → AFGHANISTAN → renewed confrontation after 1979

CORE CLAIM
- ASIA → Korea, Vietnam and China
- LATIN AMERICA → Cuba and Chile

MECHANISM
- MIDDLE EAST → Suez and Arab-Israeli wars
- AFGHANISTAN → renewed confrontation after 1979

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- ASIA → Korea, Vietnam and China
- LATIN AMERICA → Cuba and Chile

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MIDDLE EAST → Suez and Arab-Israeli wars; AFGHANISTAN → renewed confrontation after 1979.

07 →

STAGE 07 MIDDLE EAST CAUSAL LAYERS

MIDDLE EAST CAUSAL LAYERS · NATIONALISM, TERRITORY AND REFUGEES · DECOLONISATION AND BORDERS · OIL AND STATE SECURITY · INTERNATIONALISE RATHER THAN CREATE ALL CAUSES

LOCAL → nationalism, territory and refugees → POST-IMPERIAL → decolonisation and borders → STRATEGIC → oil and state security → SUPERPOWERS → internationalise rather than create all causes

CORE CLAIM
- LOCAL → nationalism, territory and refugees
- POST-IMPERIAL → decolonisation and borders

MECHANISM
- STRATEGIC → oil and state security
- SUPERPOWERS → internationalise rather than create all causes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LOCAL → nationalism, territory and refugees
- POST-IMPERIAL → decolonisation and borders

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SUPERPOWERS → internationalise rather than create all causes.

08 →

STAGE 08 DETENTE MECHANISM

DETENTE MECHANISM · NUCLEAR RISK BECOMES UNDENIABLE · SALT I 1972 · ARMS COMPETITION REGULATED · US-CHINA OPENING · TRIANGULAR DIPLOMACY · HELSINKI 1975 · NORMS WITHOUT ENDING RIVALRY

CUBA → nuclear risk becomes undeniable → SALT I 1972 → arms competition regulated → US-CHINA OPENING → triangular diplomacy → HELSINKI 1975 → norms without ending rivalry

CORE CLAIM
- CUBA → nuclear risk becomes undeniable
- SALT I 1972 → arms competition regulated

MECHANISM
- US-CHINA OPENING → triangular diplomacy
- HELSINKI 1975 → norms without ending rivalry

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CUBA → nuclear risk becomes undeniable
- SALT I 1972 → arms competition regulated

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: US-CHINA OPENING → triangular diplomacy; HELSINKI 1975 → norms without ending rivalry.

09 →

STAGE 09 NON-ALIGNMENT AS AGENCY

NON-ALIGNMENT AS AGENCY · NO AUTOMATIC BLOC MEMBERSHIP · ROOM FOR INDEPENDENT POLICY · AID AND SUPPORT SOUGHT FROM BOTH SIDES · PRESSURE PERSISTS DESPITE AUTONOMY · CLOSE DISTINCTION · BIPOLAR STRUCTURE DID NOT ERASE NON-ALIGNMENT, DECOLONISED-STATE AGENCY, INTRA-BLOC

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
REFUSAL → no automatic bloc membership	LEVERAGE → aid and support sought from both sides	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Bipolar structure did not erase non-alignment, decolonised-state agency, intra-bloc disputes or the Sino-Soviet split
SOVEREIGNTY → room for independent policy	CAUTION → pressure persists despite autonomy	proxy arenas had local causes and actors.

CORE CLAIM
- REFUSAL → no automatic bloc membership
- SOVEREIGNTY → room for independent policy

MECHANISM
- LEVERAGE → aid and support sought from both sides
- CAUTION → pressure persists despite autonomy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Bipolar structure did not erase non-alignment, decolonised-state agency, intra-bloc disputes or the Sino-Soviet split
- proxy arenas had local causes and actors.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Bipolar structure did not erase non-alignment, decolonised-state agency, intra-bloc disputes or the Sino-Soviet split; proxy arenas had local causes and actors.

10 →

STAGE 10 COMMUNIST BLOC FRACTURE

COMMUNIST BLOC FRACTURE · AFTER 1956 · SINO-SOVIET RELATIONS DETERIORATE · DISPUTE WIDENS · US-CHINA OPENING EXPLOITS THE RIFT · COMMUNIST CHINA ATTACKS COMMUNIST VIETNAM · EVIDENCE LIMIT · NUCLEAR DETERRENCE CONSTRAINED DIRECT SUPERPOWER WAR BUT ENABLED ARMS

AFTER 1956 → Sino-Soviet relations deteriorate → DOCTRINE/TERRITORY → dispute widens → 1972 → US-China opening exploits the rift → 1979 → communist China attacks communist Vietnam → EVIDENCE LIMIT: Nuclear deterrence constrained direct superpower war but enabled arms racing and risk

CORE CLAIM
- AFTER 1956 → Sino-Soviet relations deteriorate
- DOCTRINE/TERRITORY → dispute widens

MECHANISM
- 1972 → US-China opening exploits the rift
- 1979 → communist China attacks communist Vietnam

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Nuclear deterrence constrained direct superpower war but enabled arms racing and risk
- détente was managed competition, not the end of ideology or conflict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Nuclear deterrence constrained direct superpower war but enabled arms racing and risk; détente was managed competition, not the end of ideology or conflict.

11 →

STAGE 11 COLD WAR ANSWER SPINE

COLD WAR ANSWER SPINE · SECURITY DILEMMA READ THROUGH IDEOLOGY · BERLIN, KOREA AND CUBA DEFINE LIMITS · LOCAL CAUSES, AGENCY AND FRACTURED BLOCS · STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS PLUS REFORM AND NON-USE OF FORCE

ORIGINS → security dilemma read through ideology → CRISES → Berlin, Korea and Cuba define limits → GLOBAL → local causes, agency and fractured blocs → END → structural weakness plus reform and non-use of force

CORE CLAIM
- ORIGINS → security dilemma read through ideology
- CRISES → Berlin, Korea and Cuba define limits

MECHANISM
- GLOBAL → local causes, agency and fractured blocs
- END → structural weakness plus reform and non-use of force

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- ORIGINS → security dilemma read through ideology
- CRISES → Berlin, Korea and Cuba define limits

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: END → structural weakness plus reform and non-use of force.

E →

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · FEAR OF NUCLEAR CATASTROPHE · AMERICAN EXHAUSTION AND DISAPPOINTMENT AFTER VIETNAM · WEST EUROPEAN DESIRE FOR STABILITY · TRIANGULAR PRESSURE CREATED BY CHINA-US RAPPROCHEMENT. · LATER INF UNDER GORBACHEV. · SS-20 VERSUS PERSHING/CRUISE MISSILE COMPETITION · FAILURE OF SALT II RATIFICATION

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- fear of nuclear catastrophe;
- American exhaustion and disappointment after Vietnam;
- West European desire for stability;
- triangular pressure created by China-US rapprochement.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- later INF under Gorbachev;
- SS-20 versus Pershing/Cruise missile competition;
- failure of SALT II ratification;
- Soviet intervention in Afghanistan;

LEGACY / NUANCE
- persistence of deep mutual suspicion.
- after the Second World War, many newly emerging states wanted to remain neutral or non-aligned in the struggle between communism and capitalism;
- in Asia, the Korean War and SEATO showed that many states wanted to stay uncommitted rather than enter bloc politics.
- Kennan / containment is central to orthodox interpretation.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels